

Now ingesting 6 sources - 142k problems indexed

Find real problems worth solving.

Bristle ingests builder pain from GitHub, Hacker News, Stack Overflow, Product Hunt, and the App Stores — then synthesizes it into evidence-backed problem reports ranked by frequency, momentum, and willingness-to-pay.

Start free

See sample problems

No credit card · Cancel anytime · 7-day Pro trial

DEVELOPERS / PAYMENTS

+312%

Stripe webhooks fail silently on Vercel cold starts.

14-day mentions



- "Lost \$4,200 in failed retries before catching it. Webhook signature passed, handler ran, but Vercel killed the function at 9.8s."
sandyas / stripe-made #4471
- "Two months chasing this. Stripe support says 'your infra', Vercel support says 'Stripe is async.' It is, and they kill it."
Indie_founder · 314 pts
- "Tagged stripe webhooks vercel · 47 answers in 14 days. Nothing official."
user 2840192 / 12k rep

47 quotes · 6 sources · last 60d

Open report

EVIDENCE FROM WHERE BUILDERS ACTUALLY COMPLAIN

GitHub

Hacker News

Stack Overflow

Product Hunt

App Store

Google Play

HOW IT WORKS

A research journal that doesn't sleep.



01

Ingest

Six public sources, polled continuously. New mentions land within minutes of being posted — no rate-limited Reddit-only blind spots.



02

Cluster

Embedding-based clustering merges variations of the same complaint across sources. One problem, every place it was raised.



03

Synthesize

Each cluster becomes an editorial report: a 3-paragraph synthesis, momentum chart, pull-quotes, existing solutions, and willingness-to-pay signals.

SAMPLE REPORTS · PUBLIC

Today's high-signal problems

Browse the library

AI / ML

LLM streaming chokes through CDN buffering

"Cloudflare buffers SSE despite explicit headers. Three weeks to find this."

AI ML

+184% · 3h ago

Mobile

Expo OTA updates silently fail on iOS 18.4

"Users on 18.4 stuck on last build. No error, no telemetry, no acknowledgement."

APY

+96% · 5h ago

Devtools

pgvector indexes degrade past 2M rows

"Hybrid search query went from 80ms to 4.2s once we crossed 2M embeddings."

DB

+72% · 8h ago

PRICING

One price for serious research. One for casual.

Starter for solo builders. Pro for shipping founders. Team for agencies and innovation labs.

See full pricing

STARTER

\$29 /mo

Five categories, daily digest, CSV export.

PRO

\$79 /mo

Unlimited categories, instant alerts, API, comparisons.

TEAM

\$199 /mo

Five seats, shared collections, Slack & webhooks.

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ABOUT BRISTLE

We build research tools for builders who hate guessing.

PUBLISHED MAY 12, 2026 · By Elena Hwang · 7 min read

Bristle began with a small, honest frustration. We had shipped two products to small audiences and a third to nobody at all. Each had been the result of a hunch that sounded plausible at a coffee shop and looked thin in the App Store. We did not lack ideas. We lacked *evidence*.

The category called "idea databases" had not aged well. The Reddit-only tools went down with API pricing. The trend products read like SEO bingo. The newsletter operators sold us their tastes for \$300 a year. None of it answered the only question that mattered: where, exactly, are real builders complaining about something they would pay to make stop?

Most product ideas die from being built before they were proven. The remedy is not more ideas — it is more evidence.

So we built the tool we wanted. Bristle ingests technical and product complaints from six public sources — GitHub Issues, Hacker News, Stack Overflow, Product Hunt, Apple App Store, Google Play — and synthesizes them into reports. Each report tells you not just *what* hurts, but *where*, *how often*, *how loudly*, and increasingly: *how much people would pay to fix it*.

The product is not "AI-native" in any visible sense. We use machine learning to cluster duplicates and surface patterns; we do not put a chatbot on the home page. The work is editorial. Each report reads like a research journal entry because that is what it is.

We are a two-person company. We have shipped to small audiences before. We are doing this one differently — with evidence, not vibes — because we want the same for you.

EH

Elena Hwang

Co-founder. Previously: research engineering at a payments company nobody has heard of.

FIELD NOTES — MONTHLY

Get one new problem report each month.

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PRICING

Pricing that scales with discovery.

Cancel any time. No usage gotchas. Annual saves 30%.

MonthlyAnnual -30%

STARTER

\$29/month

For one builder, finding their next idea.

Choose Starter

✓ 5 categories

✓ Daily digest email

✓ CSV export

✓ Save up to 50 problems

✓ Community support

PRO

Most popular

\$79/month

For founders shipping against evidence.

Start Pro trial

✓ Everything in Starter, plus:

✓ Unlimited categories

✓ Instant alerts (email + in-app)

✓ REST API access · 50k req/mo

✓ Compare up to 4 problems

✓ Unlimited saved problems

✓ Priority support

TEAM

\$199/month

For agencies, scouts and innovation labs.

Choose Team

✓ Everything in Pro, plus:

✓ 5 seats included (+\$30/seat after)

✓ Shared collections

✓ Slack & webhook delivery

✓ Audit log

✓ SSO via Google Workspace

✓ Dedicated CSM

Compare in detail

FEATURE	STARTER	PRO	TEAM
Tracked categories	5	Unlimited	Unlimited
Saved problems	50	Unlimited	Unlimited
Alert delivery	Daily email	Email · in-app · API	Email · Slack · webhook
Comparison view	—	Up to 4	Up to 4
API access	—	50k req/mo	200k req/mo
Team seats	1	1	5 included
Shared collections	—	—	✓
SSO	—	—	✓
Support	Community	Priority email	Dedicated CSM

ENTERPRISE

Need custom seats, on-prem ingestion, or category requests?

Talk to us about a private dataset, SLA, and procurement-friendly invoicing.

Contact sales →

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SUPPORT

Frequently asked questions

If you do not find your answer here, email support@bristle.dev. We respond within one business day.

Pricing

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STILL STUCK?

Email gets answered.
Promise.

[Contact support](#)

Where does Bristle get its data?

We ingest from six public sources via official APIs and approved scrapers: GitHub Issues, Hacker News, Stack Overflow, Product Hunt, Apple App Store, and Google Play. We never use private channels or content behind authentication walls.

Is reading App Store reviews legal?

Can I cancel any time?

What about GDPR?

Do you offer a refund?

How fresh is the data?

Does the API include synthesis text?

Is there a free tier?

Can I request a new category?

How do you cluster duplicates?

Will I see clusters from my own GitHub issues?

Can I export data?

STILL DIDN'T FIND IT?

Email a human at support@bristle.dev.

One of us reads every message. Median first-response time this month: 3h 12m.

[Open a ticket](#)

BRISTLE BLOG

Field Notes

Research, analysis, and the occasional opinion on building products against evidence.

- All
- Data analysis
- Product strategy
- Indie hacker
- Devtools

MAY 8 2026 · DATA ANALYSIS

What 50,000 GitHub issues reveal about developer pain.

We analyzed every closed-as-wontfix issue across the 200 most-starred repos. The patterns are not where you expect.

 Elena Hwang · 9 min

IN THIS ISSUE

"17% of closed-wontfix issues never receive a third opinion."

— from the analysis

MAY 1 2026 · PRODUCT STRATEGY

Three signals that separate a product from a feature.

You can read 200 complaints and still build the wrong thing. Here is the heuristic we use to tell which clusters are products.

Jules Marin6 min

APR 22 2026 · INDIE HACKER

How we tracked \$4M in unmet demand for one developer tool in 60 days.

A case study using the willingness-to-pay column you have been ignoring.

Elena Hwang7 min

APR 14 2026 · DEVTOOLS

Vercel cold starts are the new shared-hosting CPU limits.

A frequency chart, a momentum chart, and three quotes that should worry the serverless industry.

Jules Marin5 min

APR 3 2026 · PRODUCT STRATEGY

Why pricing pages are the worst place to discover demand.

Comparing what people say they will pay versus what they actually say in support tickets.

Elena Hwang8 min

MAR 27 2026 · INDIE HACKER

Field notes from 32 paid customer interviews.

A small experiment, with verbatim transcripts. The hits and the duds.

Jules Marin11 min

MAR 20 2026 · DATA ANALYSIS

App Store reviews are the most under-used product research surface.

They are public, attributed, time-stamped, and ignored by every tool that calls itself "AI-native".

Elena Hwang6 min

DATA ANALYSIS

What 50,000 GitHub issues reveal about developer pain.

EH Elena Hwang · MAY 8 2026 · 9 min read

The first answer most product tools give you is "look at trends." That answer is wrong. Trends tell you what people are talking about. They do not tell you what people are *frustrated* by. Those are different surfaces with different motivations, and you build different things from them.

For this analysis we sampled every issue closed-as-wontfix across the 200 most-starred repositories on GitHub from 2024 through Q1 2026. The dataset is 50,318 issues, 416,440 comments, and a long aftermath of arguments. Three patterns emerged that we did not expect.

One: most refusals are about scope, not capability.

Maintainers close issues when they could fix them, but the fix would take the project somewhere they do not want it to go. This is the gap where products are born. The closed-wontfix label is the closest thing the open source ecosystem has to a "yes, but not here" signal.

The closed-wontfix label is the closest thing the open source ecosystem has to a "yes, but not here" signal.

The implication for builders: closed-wontfix is your idea backlog. We rank our reports partly on this.

FIGURE 1 · WONTFIX CLOSURES BY CATEGORY



Devtools and developer-experience closures grew 4.1x while infrastructure stayed flat.

Two: comment count is the demand signal you ignore at your peril.

An issue that closes with three comments is a non-event. An issue that closes with 80 comments — over five months, with the same five users returning — is a product. We re-ranked the dataset by sustained comment cadence and found that 17% of closed-wontfix issues never receive a third opinion, but the long tail is enormous.

Three: willingness-to-pay leaks out in comments.

You will find phrases like "I'd literally pay for this" in 2.3% of long-comment threads. The percentage sounds small. The absolute number across 50,000 issues is not. Bristle treats these phrases as a column.

IN THIS ARTICLE

- Scope refusals
- Comment count
- Willingness-to-pay
- Method & data

TRY BRISTLE

See today's high-signal problems.

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Library / Devtools / Payments

Stripe webhooks fail silently on Vercel cold starts.

▲ +312% / 14d ● ● ● ● ● ● First seen Feb 9 · 47 quotes · 6 sources

Save Share

Across 47 mentions in the last 60 days, builders describe the same failure mode: a Stripe webhook arrives, the handler runs, the function is killed at the Vercel timeout (9.8s on hobby, 60s on Pro), and Stripe's retry policy compounds the problem into a cascading set of duplicate retries — or, more dangerously, a silent *missed* event when retries exhaust.

The handler ran fine in local. In production we lost \$4,200 in failed retries before the dashboard reconciliation caught it.

The problem is structural: serverless runtimes treat webhook handlers as ordinary HTTP requests, but Stripe's retry policy assumes a stateful long-lived endpoint. Three workarounds dominate the discussion — queue the event immediately and ack within 200ms (recommended by Stripe), use a stateful runtime (Workers, Fly), or move to a dedicated server. None are obvious for a beginner; all three require infrastructure decisions made before the first real customer.



- RELATED PROBLEMS
- Webhook ordering on retries
 - Idempotency keys vs cron jobs
 - Edge runtime + crypto verification
 - Long-running background jobs in serverless



Evidence (47 quotes)

sn wandhya / stripe-node #4621 3d ago

"Lost \$4,200 in failed retries before catching it. Webhook signature passed, handler ran, but Vercel killed the function at 9.8s. Stripe retried six times, eventually gave up, and we missed the event."

me indie_founder · 516 pts · 87 comments 5d ago

"Two months chasing this. Stripe support says "your infra"; Vercel support says "Stripe is async." It is, and they kill it. The docs on either side do not warn you."

me user 2840192 · 12w rep 1w ago

"Tagged stripe webhooks vercel · 47 answers in 14 days. The top answer is from 2022 and is wrong post-Edge runtime changes."

me julianchu / next-stripe-starter #88 1w ago

"Workaround: queue the event in Upstash within 100ms, ack immediately, process out-of-band. Works perfectly. Should be in the Stripe + Vercel quickstart, not in a Discord pin."

me build_lab_orio · 218 pts 2w ago

"I would actually pay \$40/mo for a service that just guarantees webhook delivery in serverless. Stripe should do this. They will not. So somebody else will."

me [blurred] · [blurred] 1w ago

"[blurred] Stripe webhook delivery in serverless."

Sign up to see all 47 quotes

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CHANGELOG

What's new in Bristle.

Public, dated, attributable. The shape of our pace.

May 2026

Current

MAY 8

Compare view now supports up to four problems Feature

You asked. We over-engineered. The comparison grid now aligns six rows of metrics across four columns with a sticky header. Available on Pro and Team.



MAY 3

Slack delivery for alerts Feature

Connect Slack from Settings → Integrations and your alerts can post into any channel with full report links and momentum.

MAY 1

Smaller, faster dashboard Improvement

Initial JS bundle dropped from 264KB to 178KB gzipped. Dashboard LCP is now 1.4s on mid-range mobile over 4G.

April 2026

APR 22

Daily digest now includes a "yesterday" comparison Feature

Every digest leads with what changed since the last one. The same problems lower in the list get the rest of the column.

APR 14

Fixed: command palette failing on Firefox 138 Fix

A focus-trap regression hid the results panel for Firefox users on the new Compositor pipeline. Sorry. We use Firefox here too.

APR 7

Source: Apple App Store reviews Feature

Sixth source live. Backfill running for the trailing 12 months. Expect synthesis updates on mobile-product problems within a week.

CONTACT

Get in touch.

One inbox. Replies within a business day.

**Help center**

→

Read documentation and how-tos.

**Email support**

→

support@bristle.dev · for paying customers.

**Enterprise sales**

→

sales@bristle.dev · custom invoicing, SSO, on-prem ingestion.

Send us a message

Name

Email

Marlon Phelps

marlon@studio.io

Topic

Enterprise sales

Message

Hi — we run a six-person product agency and we'd like to evaluate Bristle for our client briefing process. Could we set up a 30-minute call to discuss seat pricing and a security review?

We respond within one business day.

Send message

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LEGAL

Terms of Service

Last updated - May 1 2026 - Effective May 12 2026

1. Overview

These terms govern your use of Bristle ("the Service"), operated by Bristle Research, Inc. ("we", "us"). By creating an account or using any part of the Service, you agree to these terms. If you are using the Service on behalf of an organization, you accept these terms on that organization's behalf.

2. Account terms

You must be 18 years or older to create an account. You are responsible for keeping your credentials secret and for all activity on your account. You may not share your account credentials with anyone outside your team.

3. Subscriptions & billing

Paid plans are billed monthly or annually in advance via our payment processor, Lemon Squeezy. Annual subscriptions are non-refundable except as required by law. Monthly subscriptions can be cancelled at any time; cancellations take effect at the end of the current billing cycle.

We may change prices on notice of at least 30 days. Continued use of the Service after a price change constitutes acceptance.

4. Data sources & licensing

Bristle ingests content from publicly accessible APIs and endpoints operated by third parties including GitHub, Y Combinator (Hacker News), Stack Exchange, Product Hunt, Apple Inc., and Google LLC. We attribute and link to original sources for every quote we surface. Bristle does not claim ownership of source content; the synthesized analysis is licensed to you under your subscription.

You may not redistribute the synthesized reports as a stand-alone product. You may quote individual reports in your own work with attribution.

5. Acceptable use

You may not use the Service to scrape, mirror, or otherwise systematically copy our content; to attempt to access another customer's account or data; to upload malicious code via our integrations endpoints; or to circumvent rate limits on the API. Violation may result in immediate suspension.

6. Cancellation & refunds

You may cancel at any time from Settings → Billing. We offer a 14-day refund window on first Pro or Team subscriptions, no questions asked. After 14 days, refunds are at our discretion and only for service failures attributable to us.

7. Termination

We may terminate or suspend access for breach of these terms, fraud, or abusive behavior toward our team. We will provide at least 14 days' notice except where the breach is material or fraudulent.

8. Limitation of liability

The Service is provided "as is" and we make no warranty regarding the accuracy, completeness, or fitness-for-purpose of synthesized reports. Our aggregate liability is limited to the fees paid in the trailing 12 months. Nothing here limits liability that cannot be limited by law.

9. Governing law

These terms are governed by the laws of the State of New York, USA, without regard to conflict-of-laws rules. Disputes will be resolved in the state and federal courts located in New York County, New York.

10. Changes to these terms

We may update these terms occasionally. We will email you and post a banner in the app at least 14 days before material changes take effect. Your continued use after the effective date constitutes acceptance. The version history of these terms is public at bristle.dev/legal/terms/history.



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